AHLI SWITZLER | CASE STUDY 5

A Verbatim-Quote Trailer Format for Podcast Marketing

As creative director for podcast trailers at Future Media, I worked within the studio's four-part format and directed the storylines across more than 50 episodes.

THE CHALLENGE

Podcast trailers have about a minute to make a stranger press play. Scripted voiceover sounds like an ad, and loosely cut highlights wander. The shows I worked on cover legal, healthcare, and professional services topics, where a guest's credibility is the selling point.

ROLE AND TOOLS

Creative director for trailers and storyline development at Future Media. Claude for drafting script options from transcripts, with saved instructions that enforce the format.

THE PROCESS

1. Read the full episode transcript and pull the moments with the most tension or surprise.
2. Build each trailer in four parts: a hook that stops the scroll, a guest intro in their own voice, a body that shows what the episode delivers, and a cliffhanger that withholds the payoff.
3. Use verbatim guest quotes only. No narration and no paraphrase, so every line is something the guest actually said.
4. Draft five one-minute options per episode, then pick and refine the strongest for the edit.

WHAT I CAUGHT AND DECIDED

- Verbatim-only keeps every trailer honest and approval-ready, since there's nothing for a guest to object to.
- The cliffhanger matters most. Ending on an unanswered question earns the click better than a summary does.
- I built a repeatable production system around the format, with saved AI instructions for trailer options, transcript proofreading, publishing copy, and visual research.

THE RESULT

A consistent trailer format applied across 50+ episodes and multiple client shows, plus a production workflow that lets one person deliver a full marketing package per episode.